separated by a high concrete wall and a checkpoint, had no running water for three months before Abu Khdair's murder.

"We're treated like fifth-class citizens in this country," said Abed Basit, a nurse from neighboring Beit Hanina who visited the mourning tent one night.

So there was a siege mentality in this part of town, even before Abu Khdair's murder. On 15 May, Israel's Independence Day on the Gregorian calendar, several Palestinians were arrested at Damascus Gate for trying to commemorate the *Nakba* ("catastrophe"), the Arabic name for the mass expulsion and displacement of Palestinians that accompanied the creation of the state. "We live here but the state does not see us as equals, it sees us as a threat," said one of them, Abed Hassoura. He held a portrait of his son Louay, who had been jailed three years before on vague security-related charges.

Two weeks later, tens of thousands of religious Jews descended on the city for Jerusalem Day, the annual state-sponsored outpouring of racism that commemorates the 1967 occupation. They marched through the Old City, singing nationalist songs and harassing the Palestinians who live and work there. Naftali Bennett led a midnight march through Sheikh Jarrah while the neighborhood's residents shut their doors and windows.

Outside Damascus Gate, a mother explained to her two sons in New York-accented English that "this is an Arab neighborhood, so we don't normally come here, but we can today because God chose us to have this city, not them." They stopped to take in the view, and her younger son, who couldn't have been more than five years old, unfurled an Israeli flag. In its center, next to the star of David, was a large sticker. It declared, "Kahane was right," in reference to the ultranationalist Rabbi Meir Kahane, the leader of Kach, which was banned in 1994 and declared a terrorist organization.

A handful of people, most of them women, tried to stage a small counter-protest at the gate, peaceably unfurling a Palestinian flag. They were hauled away by police, who barricaded the residents of Sheikh Jarrah and other areas inside their neighborhoods. An elderly resident of Silwan asked me to check on his son, who had been arrested for demonstrating. Then he scurried away, fearing he would also be detained.

One wonders whether the Ashkenazi Jews of a century ago would find these scenes disquietingly familiar: a fearful minority huddled inside its